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God Is Just

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God Is Just

He renders perfect fairness in every judgment.

The Flood and the Ark (Genesis 6:5-8; 7:23)

“The Lord saw that the wickedness of humankind had become great on the earth.... But Noah found favor in the sight of the Lord.” God judged a world that had given itself to evil. He also preserved a family by grace. Justice does not sleep. Neither does it forget mercy.

Judgment on Egypt, Blood on the Door (Exodus 12:12-13)

“I will pass through the land of Egypt in the same night, and I will attack all the firstborn in the land of Egypt.... The blood will be a sign for you on the houses where you are, so that when I see the blood I will pass over you.” Pharaoh’s oppression and Egypt’s idols were answered in judgment. Israel was spared not because they were innocent, but because a lamb stood in their place. Justice fell. Deliverance came through a substitute.

The King Who Was Not Excused (2 Samuel 12:7-13)

“You are that man!... The sword will never depart from your house.” David was the Lord’s anointed, and he was not above the law of God. Nathan named the sin. David confessed. Forgiveness was real. Consequences remained. Justice is not lenient toward the powerful and not vindictive toward the broken. It is true.

Justice Satisfied at the Cross (Isaiah 53:5-6; Romans 3:25-26)

“He was wounded because of our rebellious deeds.... The Lord caused the sin of all of us to attack him.” God publicly displayed Christ “to demonstrate his righteousness... so as to be just and the justifier of the one who lives because of Jesus’ faithfulness.” The cross is not God setting justice aside. Sin is punished. The guilty who trust the Son are justified. No clearer display exists of a judgment that is holy and a mercy that is not cheap.

The Last Accounting (Revelation 20:11-12; Matthew 25:31-32)

“Then I saw a large white throne and the one who was seated on it.... The dead were judged by what was written in the books, according to their deeds.” “When the Son of Man comes in his glory... all the nations will be assembled before him.” Hidden things will not stay hidden. Partiality will not survive that light. God’s justice will stand when every other court has closed.

Daily Impact

Justice steadies the oppressed and warns the comfortable. The world is full of delayed verdicts, hidden cruelty, and courts that can be bought. God is not one of those courts. He judged a violent world, an enslaving empire, and even His own king. At the cross He did not wink at sin. He bore it. So we may wait without despair when wrong seems to win, and we may repent without delay when the wrong is ours.

Daily this attribute forbids payback, favoritism, and the quiet hope that our own sins are too small to matter. It also forbids cynicism. The last throne will not be crooked. Until that day, we do justly, love mercy, and walk humbly—because the Judge of all the earth will do what is right.

Because God is just, I will leave justice and judgment with Him and deal fairly with others.

Questions for Personal Application

1. Where am I still clutching vengeance for a wrong God has already seen?
2. Whom am I tempted to excuse or to crush because of status, closeness, or advantage—rather than dealing fairly?
3. What sin have I hoped was too small for justice, and will I bring it to the cross where justice has already spoken?
4. How should the Passover and the cross change the way I treat people who have no covering but need one?
5. In what present injustice can I wait and work without despair, because the last accounting will be true?

Word Pictures of God's Justice

The Scale with No Hidden Weight

A dishonest merchant keeps two measures: one for friends, one for strangers. God's justice has one scale. Status does not tip it. Tears do not bribe it. He renders what is right.

Blood on the Door

Judgment is passing through the land. The difference between a house of death and a house of deliverance is not innocence. It is blood God has appointed. Justice falls.

Mercy stands where the substitute has stood.

The Throne with the Open Books

At the end a white throne is set, and books are opened. Nothing stays off the record. This is not a new personality in God. It is the same justice, seen without remainder.

Reflection

These pictures remind us that justice is not God's bad mood. It is His goodness refusing to call evil good. He keeps one scale. He appoints blood for a door. He will open the books.

Because He is just, the oppressed may hope and the comfortable must wake.
Because He is just *at the cross*, the guilty may come.

We do not ask Him to look away. We take our place under the covering He has given, and we put down the hidden weights we have used on other people.

1. Where have I been keeping two measures—one scale for myself and another for someone else?
2. Have I been standing behind a door with no blood on it, hoping justice will pass me by because I am sincere, busy, or sorry enough?
3. If the books were opened today, what would I rather hide—and what will I now bring into the light while mercy still calls?

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In Christ,

The JesusOnline Ministries Team

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